Rebuilding starts with water.

A proposed first step towards farming, education and livelihoods for women and families affected by Sudan's war.

The project and the people

Virgin Mary Farm in Omdurman is Risemeup's main development project. Our founder reports a 130-hectare site belonging to the Coptic Orthodox Church in Sudan, Khartoum-Omdurman, and confirms permission to use it. Ownership documents, surveyed boundaries and written project-use terms remain subject to review.

The planned programme would support women from the Coptic Orthodox, Nuba Mountains and Blue Nile communities, including survivors of sexual violence, widows and mothers raising children alone. Farming education and livelihood opportunities would be shaped with the communities. Girls' learning would be age-appropriate, supervised and support continued schooling.

Current position: not operational

The farm was destroyed during the war. Iman Tadros reports that all seven wells were destroyed and pumping equipment stolen. No operational water supply is confirmed; new water storage is needed. A reported visit around mid-October 2026 has not been established as a technical assessment.

Our immediate request

We seek water, irrigation and agricultural specialists to help assess the wells, establish a viable initial water source and design an affordable growing and training system. Safe access, written land-use terms, local responsibilities and secure storage must be confirmed before delivery.

A practical first stage

Assess: inspect the wells and land, test water availability and quality, and confirm safe access and responsibilities.
Design and cost: agree well rehabilitation or replacement, new storage, suitable power, pumping and irrigation for an assessed growing area.
Install and train: after agreements and funding, commission the system and train its operators.
Grow and review: begin a supervised growing cycle, record performance and decide whether to expand.

Planning and assessment stage. No quotation-backed funding total or delivery date has been agreed. The first growing area may be smaller than the illustrative 20-30 hectare Phase 1 concept.

A defined contribution.
A shared community purpose.

Equipment follows assessment

Provisional needs: well restoration and pumping, solar power and controls, storage and filtration, irrigation, training tools and secure storage. Specifications will follow assessment and include delivery, installation, spare parts, training and maintenance.

Four facilities. Five recovery phases.

The original proposal, dated 19 November 2018, describes four facility components: biogas, ten greenhouses, produce sorting and packaging, and poultry. Education would run across the farm; the Mango Project is a supporting subproject. These are long-term ambitions, not existing facilities.

The newer five-phase roadmap describes a possible sequence: start production, expand growing, build commercial capacity, add value and connect the whole farm. Its areas, ambition to reach 300+ families and reinvestment approach are indicative. Feasibility, costs and financial arrangements need assessment and agreement; further partner funding may be needed at every stage.

Clear responsibilities before implementation

Iman coordinates partner enquiries and machinery-donation paperwork. She identifies Bishop Sarabon and farm manager Jhone Wadeea as local contacts. Equipment is intended to belong to Virgin Mary Farm together with Risemeup for the community purpose; legal title, custody, donor conditions and maintenance responsibilities must be recorded in written agreements before acceptance or delivery.

Risemeup is a London-based initiative and is not currently registered in the UK. The legal structure and eligible recipient for grants or equipment must be agreed before accepting project funding. Financial controls, safeguarding, complaints routes and named oversight need to be agreed and put into use before activities begin. Participation must not require religious observance or disclosure of trauma. Specialist support and referral services are not yet established.

Transparency and evidence

We plan to publish a validated budget summary and report on agreed support. Supporting documents can be reviewed privately when available; some remain to be assembled. The food-support archive is founder-supplied, with dates and totals unverified. Plans and illustrations do not represent achieved results.

Discuss a contribution with Iman

Iman Tadros | Founder, Risemeup
i.tadros@risemeup.org | +44 7867 977 844
www.risemeup.org/development-partners/

Please introduce your organisation and the expertise or component you would like to discuss. Agree a suitable private channel before sharing sensitive documents.